

 NAIROBI NEXUS

Production-Grade AI Newsletter System

Week 10 Final Capstone Project • n8n Automation Workflow

Lead Automation Engineer

Anthony Waliaula

Documentation & Slides

Anne Nyambura

Submission Date

Sunday, 7th June 2026

Workflow Stats

- 39 Total Nodes
- 5 News Sources
- 3 Fault Tolerance Layers
- 100% Structured AI Output
- 2× Model Fallback Coverage

01

Project Description

To solve Kamau's challenge at Nairobi Nexus — manually monitoring 5 separate Kenyan publications every week — we designed, deployed, and hardened a fully automated, parallel-processing newsletter generation workflow in n8n.

Building on the Week 8 functional prototype, the Week 10 production system introduces four key upgrades: structured JSON output validation across all agents, multi-layer fault tolerance, deliberate model selection with per-branch fallbacks, and full operational logging with governance signals.

The system wakes up every Friday at 2:00 PM (Africa/Nairobi time) via a Schedule Trigger and simultaneously fires 5 independent HTTP requests to fetch live RSS feeds from TechCabal, Business Daily Africa, The Star Kenya, Standard Media Kenya, and Kenyan Wall Street. Each feed is processed by its own dedicated AI Field Reporter agent, which extracts the top headline and returns strictly validated JSON. The 5 structured summaries are merged and passed to the Chief Editor — Kamau — who synthesises a witty, Nairobi street-smart newsletter, validated by a separate Structured Output Parser. The final draft is logged to Google Sheets and dispatched via Gmail.

02

Week 8 → Week 10: What Changed and Why

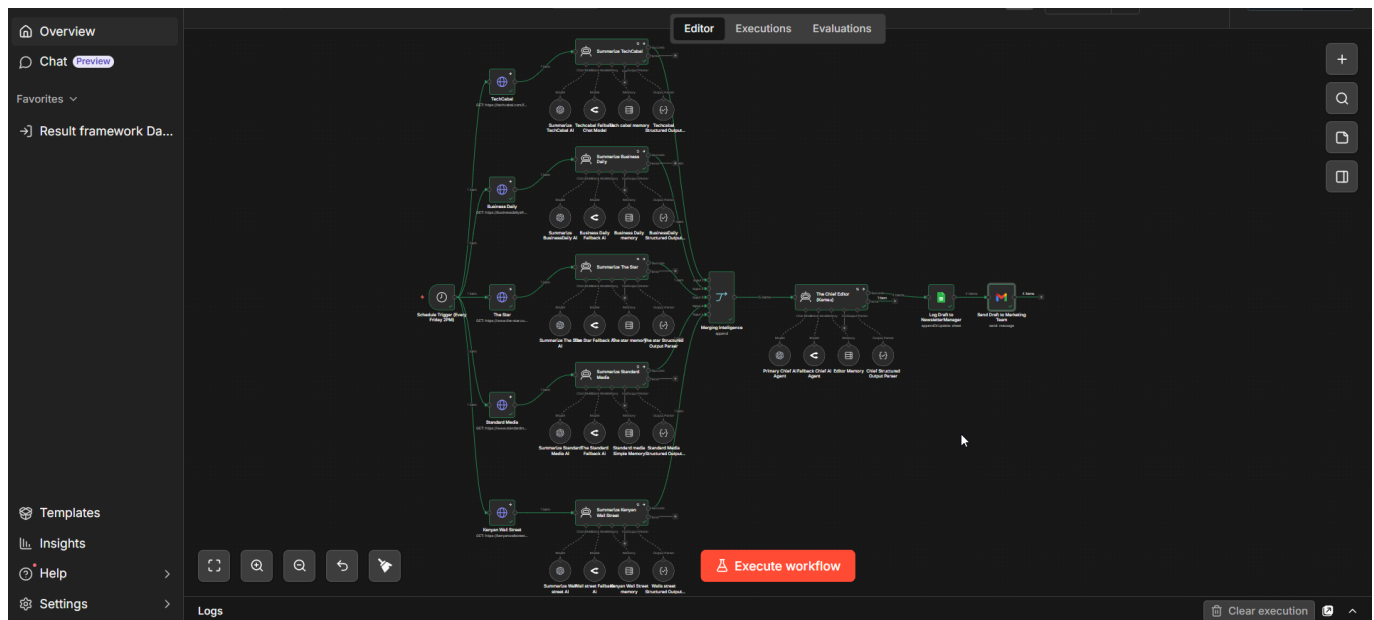
The Week 8 prototype was functional but had critical weaknesses that would cause silent failures in production. The table below maps each problem to its fix.

Dimension	Week 8 Prototype	Week 10 Production
AI Output Validation	Free-form Markdown — AI could return anything	Strict JSON via Structured Output Parser on every agent
Chief Editor Schema	Wrong schema: article fields (source, headline) applied to newsletter output	Correct schema: newsletter_title, newsletter_body, sources_used, word_count
Downstream Reliability	Google Sheets mapping returned 'undefined' — wrong field key	Reliable \$json.output.newsletter_body — always resolves correctly
Field Reporter Fallbacks	None — primary model failure = branch failure	All 5 Field Reporters have independent OpenRouter fallback models
Logging Depth	Date + draft body only	Date, sources count, newsletter title, body, model used — fully auditable
Rate Limiting	5 agents firing simultaneously caused API throttling	executeOnce + branch isolation reduces concurrent API calls

03

Workflow Architecture

The workflow implements true distributed parallel computing across 5 independent branches, each containing a paired HTTP Request node, AI Field Reporter agent, Structured Output Parser, Memory node, and fallback LLM — before converging at a central Merge node.



Caption: Full n8n workflow canvas — 39 nodes across 5 parallel branches converging at the Chief Editor

Pipeline overview:

- Schedule Trigger fires every Friday 14:00 Africa/Nairobi
- 5 HTTP Request nodes fire simultaneously (each fault-tolerant)
- Each HTTP output feeds its own dedicated AI Field Reporter agent
- Each Field Reporter has: Structured Output Parser + Memory + fallback LLM
- Merging Intelligence node (Append mode) collects all 5 outputs
- Chief Editor (Kamau) reads all 5, filters success-only, writes newsletter
- Chief Editor has: Structured Output Parser + Memory + error branch to Backup Editor
- On success: Google Sheets log + Gmail delivery
- On model failure: Fallback Chief AI Agent (Llama 3.2 via OpenRouter) takes over automatically — same output route to Sheets + Gmail

04

Structured AI Output & JSON Reliability

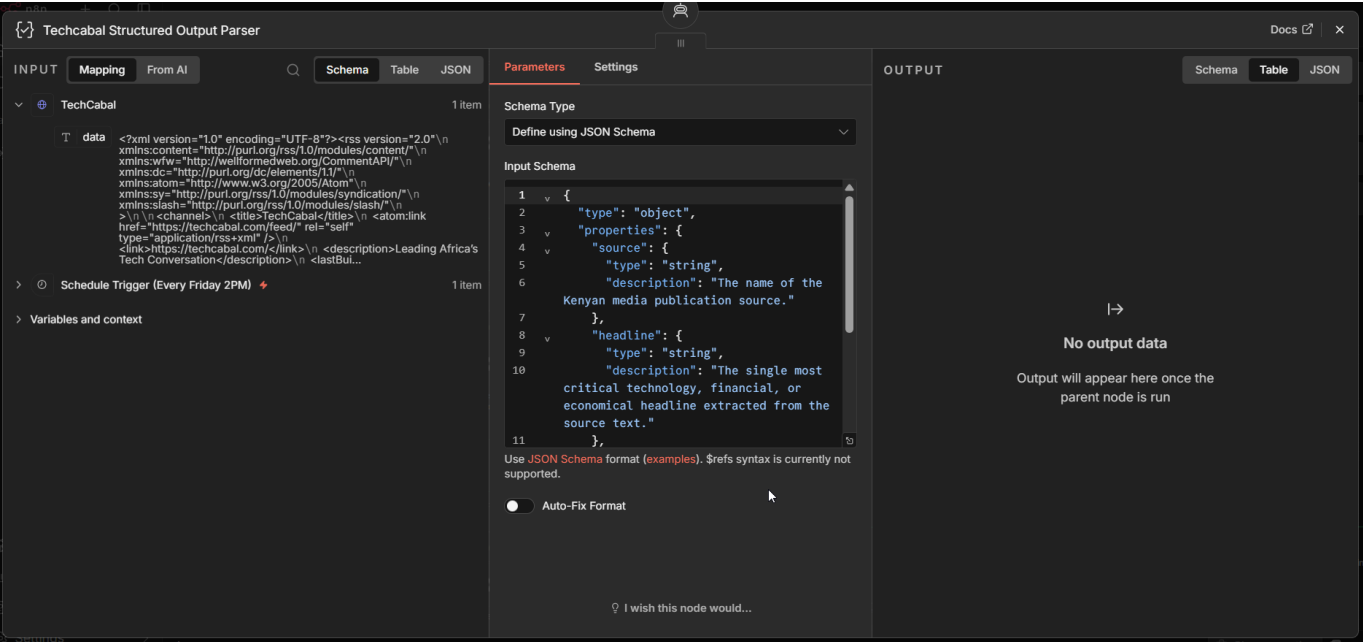
Core principle: The system should never guess what the AI meant. Every agent output is validated against a strict JSON schema before being passed downstream.

4.1 Field Reporter Schema (×5 Agents)

All 5 Field Reporter agents have a Structured Output Parser enforcing this schema:

Field	Type	Description
source	string	The name of the Kenyan media publication (e.g. 'TechCabal')
headline	string	The single most critical tech, financial, or economic headline from the source
status	string	Set to 'success' if content was parsed, or 'offline' if fallback text was supplied

Required fields: source, headline, status



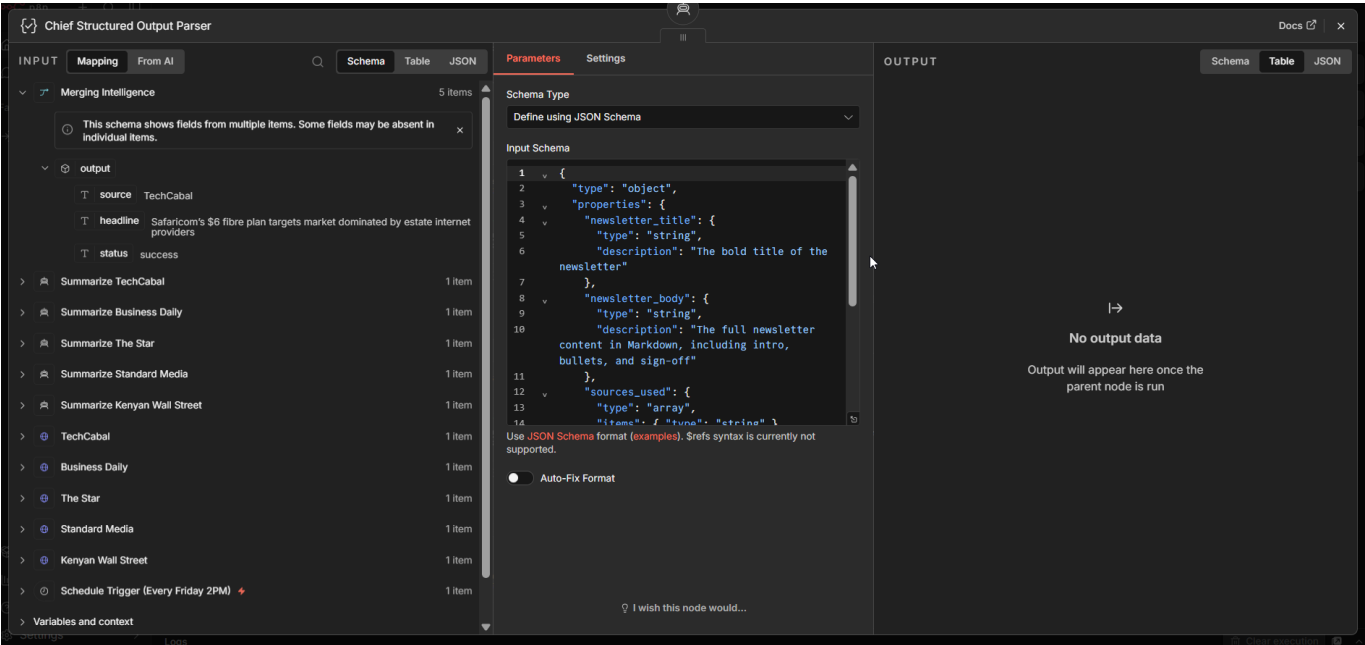
4.2 Chief Editor Schema (Kamau)

The Chief Editor has its own Structured Output Parser with a newsletter-specific schema — different from the field reporters. This was the primary bug fixed in Week 10 (the Week 8 schema incorrectly applied article fields to a newsletter output).

Field	Type	Description
newsletter_title	string	The bold title of the newsletter edition
newsletter_body	string	Full newsletter in Markdown: intro paragraph, bullet headlines, sign-off. Under 200 words. Min 3 Kenyan slang terms.

<code>sources_used</code>	<code>array[string]</code>	Array of source names where status === 'success' that were actually included
<code>word_count</code>	<code>integer</code>	Approximate word count of the newsletter_body — used for governance logging

Required fields: newsletter_title, newsletter_body, sources_used



4.3 Why Structured Output Matters Here

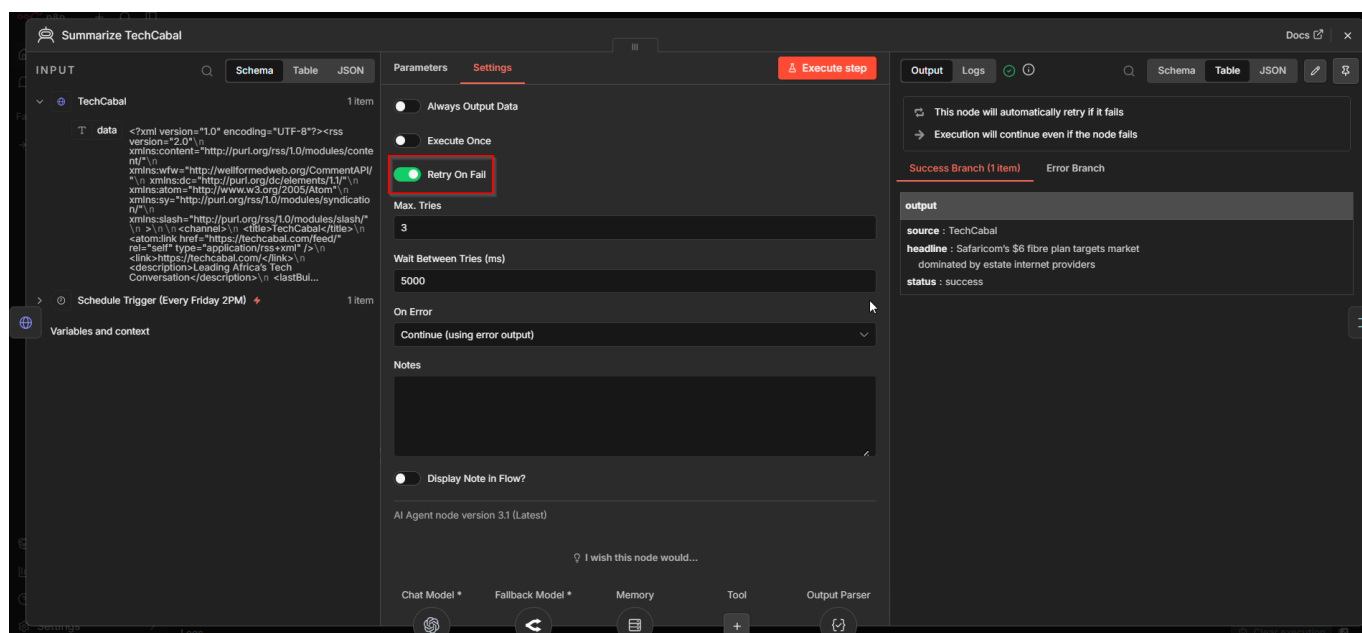
- The Google Sheets node references `$json.output.newsletter_body` — if the AI returned plain text, this would silently return undefined and log nothing
- The Gmail node uses `newsletter_title` for the email subject — unstructured output would break the subject line
- Malformed AI responses are caught and surfaced at the parser layer, not silently swallowed
- The `sources_used` array allows the Sheets log to record exactly which publications contributed each week

05 Fault Tolerance & Resilient Design

A production system degrades gracefully — it does not collapse. Three independent protection layers are stacked in this workflow.

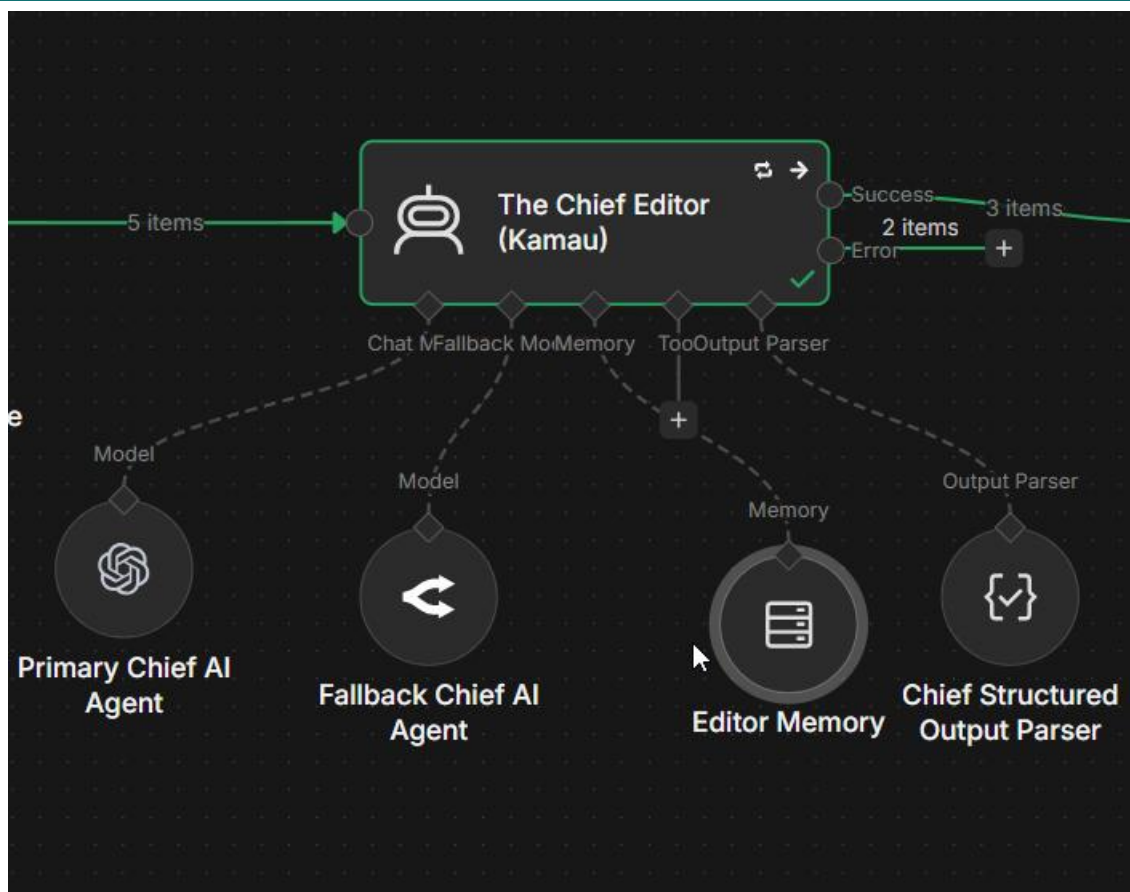
5.1 Layer 1 — HTTP Safety

- onError: continueRegularOutput is set on all 5 HTTP Request nodes
- If a source is offline, its branch passes empty/fallback content to the Field Reporter
- The Field Reporter receives the fallback signal and returns: status: 'offline'
- The Merge node collects all 5 branch outputs regardless of which sources were online
- The Chief Editor filters silently — only status === 'success' items are used



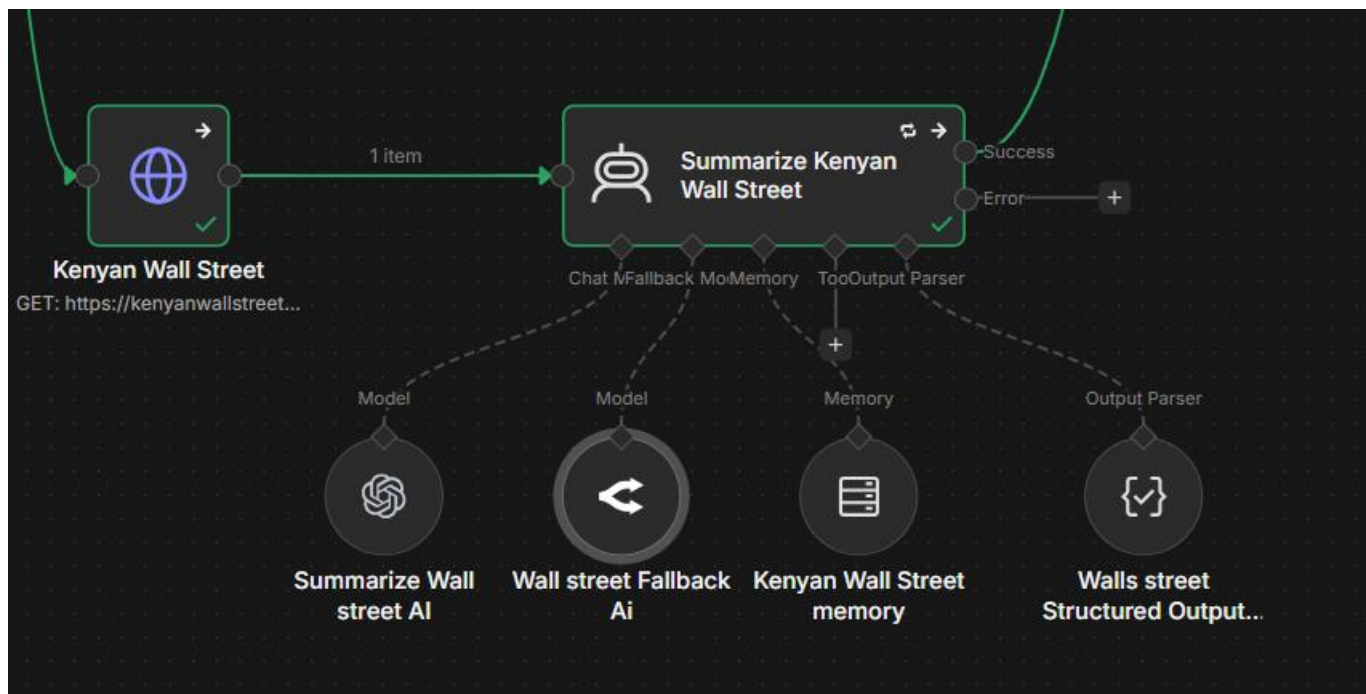
5.2 Layer 2 — Chief Editor Model Fallback

- The Chief Editor node has onError: continueErrorOutput
- If the primary gpt-5-mini times out or hits quota → the Fallback Chief AI Agent (openRouter) is invoked automatically via the secondary ai_languageModel connection
- The Fallback Chief AI Agent uses meta-llama/llama-3.2-11b-vision-instruct via OpenRouter — wired as the second language model on the same Chief Editor node
- The Chief Editor node has onError: continueErrorOutput — execution continues even if the primary model fails
- Both primary and fallback models output to the same Google Sheets + Gmail delivery nodes — no separate routing needed



5.3 Layer 3 — Per-Branch Field Reporter Fallbacks

- Each of the 5 Field Reporter AI agents has its own dedicated fallback LLM (OpenRouter)
- Business Daily, The Star, Standard Media, and Kenyan Wall Street branches each have independent fallback models
- A single reporter failing cannot cascade to other branches — each branch is fully isolated
- If a Field Reporter's primary model (gpt-5) fails, the openrouter/free fallback LLM generates the JSON summary



06

Model Selection, Constraints & Fallbacks

6.1 Model Strategy

Model choices were deliberate: primary models were selected for output quality, fallbacks for reliability and availability across different providers.

Agent	Primary Model	Fallback Model	executeOnce	Role
Field Reporters (×5)	gpt-5 (OpenAI)	openrouter/free (per branch)	No	JSON extractor
Chief Editor	gpt-5-mini (OpenAI)	meta-llama/llama-3.2-11b-vision-instruct (OpenRouter)	—	Newsletter writer
Fallback Chief AI Agent	meta-llama/llama-3.2-11b-vision-instruct (OpenRouter)	—	—	2nd LLM on Chief Editor

6.2 Chief Editor Output Constraints

The following constraints are enforced by a combination of the agent prompt and the Structured Output Parser:

- **Word limit:** Under 200 words total — hard rule in prompt. The word_count field in the JSON output allows the Sheets log to verify this after every run.
- **Kenyan slang:** Minimum 3 terms required. Accepted: Bazeng, Form ni gani, Poa sana, Manze, Unaona?, Hii ni kubwa, Wueh!, Msee, Mambo.
- **Markdown format:** newsletter_body field is enforced as a string — the parser rejects non-string output.
- **Success sources only:** The agent prompt explicitly filters status === 'success'. Offline sources are excluded silently — they are never mentioned in the newsletter.

6.3 Chief Editor Prompt (Full)

The prompt below is the exact text used in The Chief Editor (Kamau) agent node:

```
You are Kamau, the Witty Tech Editor of Nairobi Nexus newsletter.

You have received JSON summaries from 5 Kenyan news sources:
{{ JSON.stringify($input.all().map(item => item.json.output), null, 2) }}
```

```
TASK: Write this week's Nairobi Nexus newsletter intro.
```

```
STRICT RULES:
1. Use ONLY sources where "status" equals "success". Skip all others silently.
2. Under 200 words total.
```

3. Weave in Kenyan slang naturally — use at least 3 of: Bazeng, Form ni gani, Poa sana, Manze, Unaona?, Hii ni kubwa, Wueh!, Msee, Mambo.
4. Tone: energetic, witty, Nairobi street-smart but still professional.
5. Format as Markdown.

Return your response as a single JSON object with these exact keys:

- "newsletter_title": the bold title string
- "newsletter_body": the full newsletter in Markdown (intro + bullets + sign-off)
- "sources_used": array of source names you actually used
- "word_count": integer word count of newsletter_body

No code blocks. No backticks. Pure JSON only.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor with three main panels:

- Left Panel (Schema):** A tree view showing a schema for 'Merging Intelligence' with 5 items. The 'output' section lists fields: 'source' (TechCabal), 'headline' (Safaricom's \$6 fibre plan targets market dominated by estate internet providers), and 'status' (success). Below this, a list of sources is shown: Summarize TechCabal, Summarize Business Daily, Summarize The Star, Summarize Standard Media, Summarize Kenyan Wall Street, TechCabal, Business Daily, The Star, and Standard Media, each with a '1 item' count.
- Middle Panel (Expression):** Contains a JavaScript expression: `{{ JSON.stringify($input.all().map(item => item.json.output), null, 2) }}`. Below it, a task description reads: 'TASK: Write this week's Nairobi Nexus newsletter intro.' followed by 'STRICT RULES:' and a list of instructions: 1. Use ONLY sources where "status" equals "success". Skip all others silently. 2. Under 280 words total. 3. Weave in Kenyan slang naturally — use at least 3 of: Bazeng, Form ni gani, Poa sana, Manze, Unaona?, Hii ni kubwa, Wueh!, Msee, Mambo. 4. Tone: energetic, witty, Nairobi street-smart but still professional. 5. Format as Markdown. 6. No code blocks, no backticks, no labels, no explanations — output ONLY the newsletter. Below the rules, it says: 'Return your response as a single JSON object with these exact keys: - "newsletter_title": the bold title string - "newsletter_body": the full newsletter in Markdown (intro + bullets + sign-off) - "sources_used": array of source names you actually used - "word_count": integer word count of newsletter_body'. At the bottom, it states: 'No code blocks. No backticks. Pure JSON only.'
- Right Panel (Result):** Shows the output of the expression, which is a JSON array of 5 objects. Each object contains 'source', 'headline', and 'status' fields. The first object is for 'TechCabal' with a headline about Safaricom's \$6 fibre plan and a status of 'success'. The other four objects are for 'Business Daily Africa', 'The Star Kenya', 'Standard Media Kenya', and 'Kenyan Wall Street', all with a status of 'offline'.

07 Operational Logging & Governance Signals

If someone asks 'What happened last Friday?' — the system can answer. Every run appends a row to the NewsletterManager Google Sheet.

7.1 Google Sheets — Drafts Tab Column Mapping

Column	n8n Expression	What It Captures
Date	<code>\$now.setZone('Africa/Nairobi').toFormat('yyyy-MM-dd HH:mm')</code>	Execution timestamp in Nairobi timezone
Successful Sources	<code>\$json.output?.sources_used?.join(', ')</code>	Which sources succeeded (e.g. 'TechCabal, KWS')
Draft Body	<code>\$json.output?.newsletter_body</code>	Full newsletter Markdown text
Newsletter Title	<code>{{ \$json.output.newsletter_title }}</code>	The newsletter title
Model Used	<code>Primary or fallback model name</code>	Which AI model generated this run's output

[illegible]

7.2 Gmail Delivery

After logging, the workflow sends a styled HTML email to the marketing team containing the full newsletter draft for approval before publication.

- To: tonyouh@gmail.com
- Subject: newsletter_title from structured JSON output
- Body: newsletter_body rendered as HTML
- Metadata: source count, execution date, model used

The screenshot displays the 'Send Draft to Marketing Team' workflow in a no-code automation tool. The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, PARAMETERS, and OUTPUT.

INPUT: This section lists 13 items that serve as triggers or data sources for the workflow. These include 'Log Draft to NewsletterManager', 'Successful Sources', 'Newsletter Title', 'Draft Body', 'Model Used', 'The Chief Editor (Kamau)', 'Merging Intelligence', 'Summarize TechCabal', 'Summarize Business Daily', 'Summarize The Star', 'Summarize Standard Media', 'Summarize Kenyan Wall Street', 'TechCabal', 'Business Daily', 'The Star', 'Standard Media', and 'Kenyan Wall Street'.

PARAMETERS: This section shows the configuration for the 'Send Draft to Marketing Team' action. It includes fields for 'Email account', 'Message', 'Operation', 'Send', 'To', 'Subject', 'Email Type', and 'HTML'. The 'Message' field is highlighted, showing a complex HTML email template with a dark background and white text. The 'Email Type' is set to 'HTML'.

OUTPUT: This section shows the results of the action, including 'Id', 'threadid', and 'labels'. The output is displayed in a table with 3 items.

to me ▼



Nairobi Nexus Weekly Newsletter

Auto-generated — Saturday, 06 June 2026

Sources fetched: 1/5

Status: Draft ready for review

Safaricom just dropped Fibre Life and Wi-Fi Bamba from KES 800 (~\$6). Form ni gani? Wueh! Msee, this is a direct run at estate ISPs that have run the low-cost home internet hustle for years. Unaona? Hii ni kubwa — affordability meets scale.

- What it is: 10–20 Mbps plans from KES 800–2,000; Wi-Fi Bamba pilot in Kawangware, Kangemi, Kiambu Bus Park.
- Why it matters: targets price-sensitive households and estate networks; could force price cuts and service upgrades.
- Risks: last-mile logistics, quality of service, viability of ultra-low pricing.
- Watch: M-PESA billing flows, agent distribution, and whether riders switch providers.

Bazeng — keep your eyes peeled. Poa sana.

— Kamau, Witty Tech Editor, Nairobi Nexus

This draft was auto-generated by the Nairobi Nexus Newsletter Bot. Please review before publishing. Reply with edits or APPROVE to publish.

← Reply ↩ Forward 😊

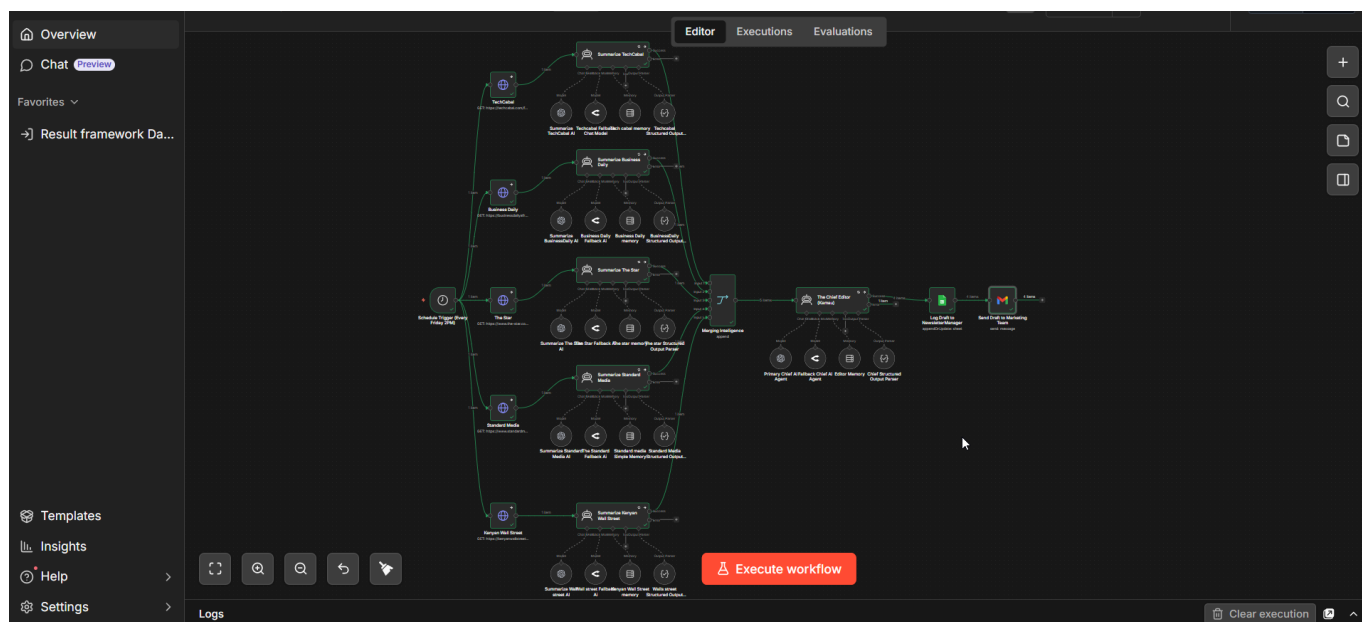
08 Node-by-Node Workflow Reference

Step	Node Name	Type	Role & Logic
1	Schedule Trigger	Schedule	Fires every Friday 14:00 Africa/Nairobi. Triggers all 5 parallel branches.
2A	HTTP - TechCabal	HTTP Request	Fetches TechCabal RSS. <code>continueRegularOutput</code> — source failure does not stop workflow.
2A	Summarize TechCabal	AI Agent	Field Reporter: gpt-5 (primary) + Techcabal Fallback Chat Model (openrouter/free). Extracts top headline as strict JSON.
2B	HTTP - Business Daily	HTTP Request	Fetches businessdailyafrica.com RSS. Fault tolerant.
2B	Summarize Business Daily	AI Agent	Field Reporter: extracts top business/finance headline as JSON.
2C	HTTP - The Star	HTTP Request	Fetches the-star.co.ke RSS. Fault tolerant.
2C	Summarize The Star	AI Agent	Field Reporter: extracts top general/tech headline as JSON.
2D	HTTP - Standard Media	HTTP Request	Fetches standardmedia.co.ke RSS. Fault tolerant.
2D	Summarize Standard Media	AI Agent	Field Reporter: extracts top tech/economy headline as JSON.
2E	HTTP - Kenyan Wall St.	HTTP Request	Fetches kenyanwallstreet.com RSS. Fault tolerant.
2E	Summarize KWS	AI Agent	Field Reporter: extracts top financial/investment headline as JSON.
—	Structured Output Parser (x5)	Output Parser	Enforces {source, headline, status} schema on each Field Reporter.
—	[Branch] Fallback AI	LLM (OpenRouter)	openrouter/free model. Each branch has its own: Techcabal Fallback, Business Daily Fallback Ai, The Star Fallback Ai, The Standard Fallback Ai, Wall street Fallback Ai.
3	Merging Intelligence	Merge (Append)	Combines all 5 Field Reporter outputs into one list.
4	The Chief Editor (Kamau)	AI Agent	Primary: gpt-5-mini. Fallback: meta-llama/llama-3.2-11b-vision-instruct (Fallback Chief AI Agent). <code>onError</code> : <code>continueErrorOutput</code> . Filters success sources, writes newsletter.
—	Chief Structured Parser	Output Parser	Enforces newsletter JSON schema (newsletter_title, newsletter_body, sources_used, word_count).
—	Fallback Chief AI Agent	LLM (OpenRouter)	meta-llama/llama-3.2-11b-vision-instruct. Connected as 2nd <code>ai_languageModel</code> on Chief Editor. Activates when gpt-5-mini fails.
5a	Log Draft — Sheets	Google Sheets	Appends row: Date, Successful Sources, Draft Body, Model Used.
5b	Send Draft — Gmail	Gmail	Sends styled HTML newsletter to marketing team for approval.

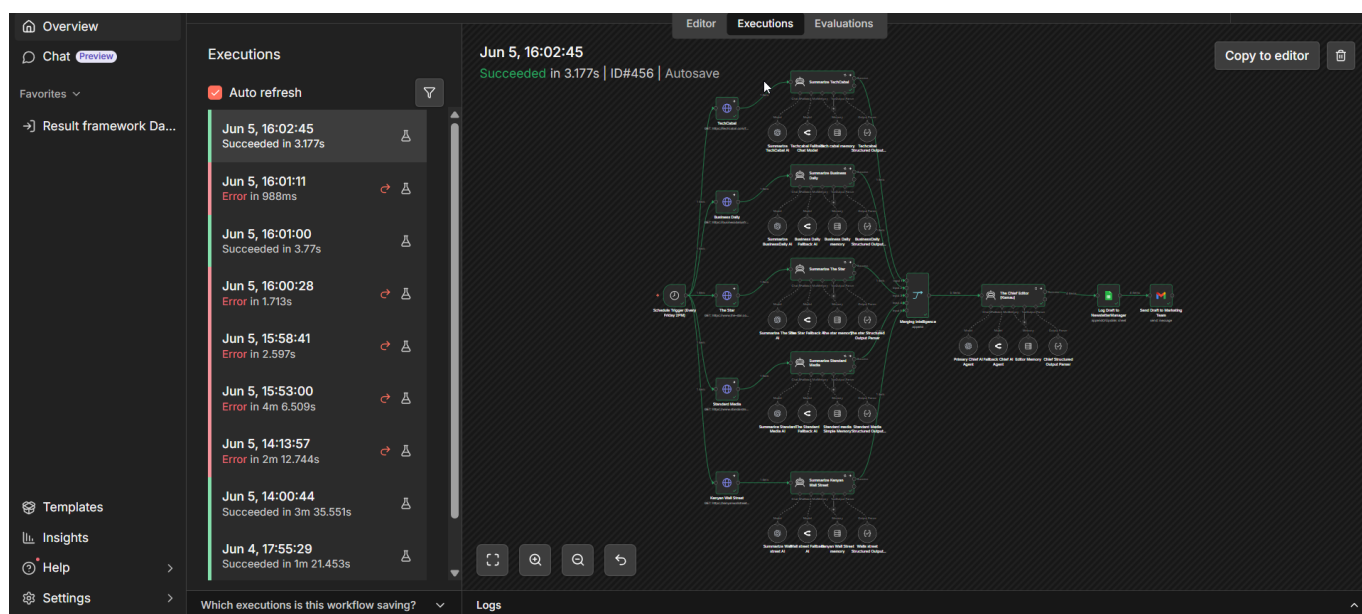
09 Workflow Evidence & Screenshots

The following screenshots provide visual proof of a successful end-to-end workflow execution. Replace each placeholder with the corresponding screenshot.

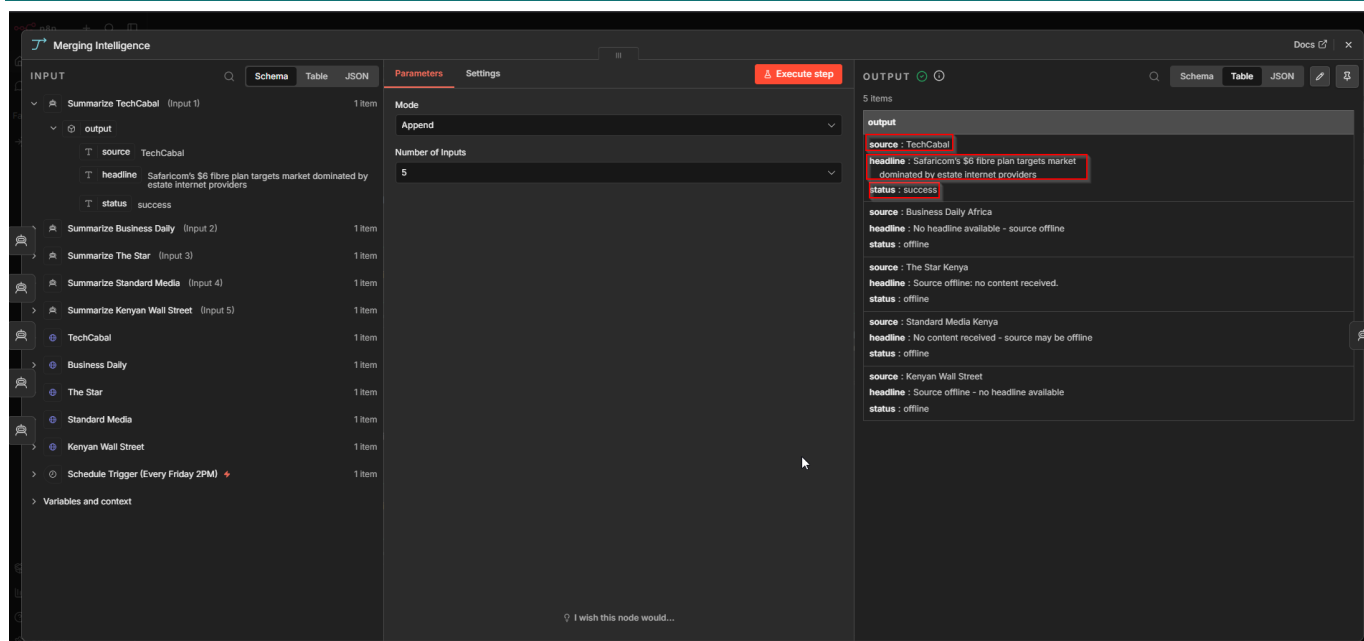
9.1 Full Workflow Canvas — Parallel Architecture



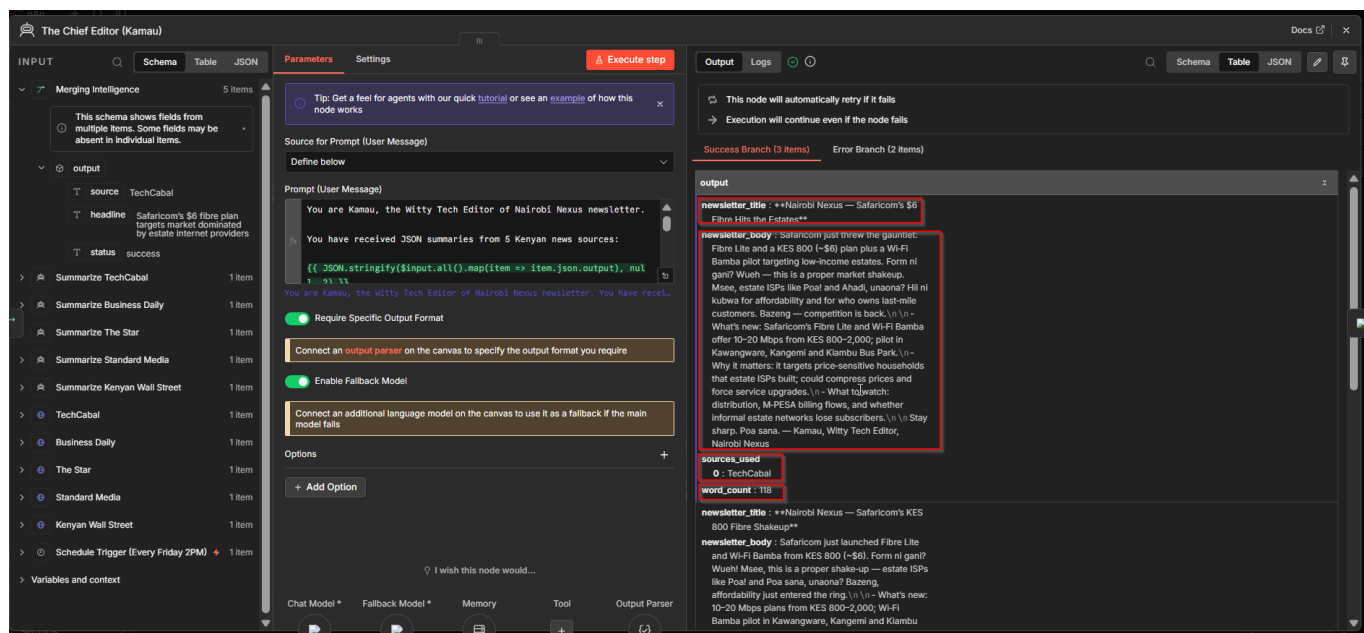
9.2 Successful Execution Run



9.3 Merging Intelligence Node — 5 Items



9.4 Chief Editor — Structured JSON Output



9.5 Offline Source Handling

Summarize Standard Media

INPUT | Schema | Table | JSON | **Parameters** | Settings | **Execute step**

Standard Media 1 item

error

message 404 - {"message": "..."}

name AxiosError

stack AxiosError: Request failed with status code 404... (truncated)

Tip: Get a feel for agents with our quick tutorial or see an example of how this node works

Source for Prompt (User Message)

Define below

Prompt (User Message)

You are a Field Reporter AI. Analyze this raw RSS/HTML content from Standard Media Kenya and extract the single most important tech or economy headline.

RAW CONTENT:

You are a Field Reporter AI. Analyze this raw RSS/HTML conte...

Options:

- ☒ Require Specific Output Format
- ☒ Enable Fallback Model

Connect an **output parser** on the canvas to specify the output format you require

Connect an additional language model on the canvas to use it as a fallback if the main model fails

Output | Logs | Schema | Table | JSON | Edit | Share

This node will automatically retry if it fails
Execution will continue even if the node fails

Success Branch (1 item) | Error Branch

output

```
{
  "source": "Standard Media Kenya",
  "headline": "No content received - source may be offline",
  "status": "offline"
}
```

Offline

9.6 NewsletterManager Google Sheet — Drafts Tab

NewsletterManager										
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help										
A2 6/1/2026 15:29:00										
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	Date	Successful Sources	Newsletter Title	Draft Body	Model Used					
2				Nairobi Nexus Weekly Update						
				Manze, it's been a quiet week for the tech scene in our hood, but don't sleep on it just yet! Hii ni kubwa — we've got a juicy scoop						
				- Nigerian business banking startup Brass merges operations into Paystack MFB — Looks like they're leveling up, but let's see if t						
	2026-06-01 15:29	1/5 sources	"Nairobi Nexus — Fibre Hustle"	Wuehl, make sure to stay tuned for more updates next week!	gpt-4o-mini					
				# Nairobi Nexus — Fibre Hustle						
				Safaricom launched a KES 800 (~\$6) Fibre Lite plan and a Wi-Fi Bamba pay-as-you-go pilot aimed at low-income estates. Manze						
				- What happened: Safaricom is testing KES 800–2,000 plans and Wi-Fi Bamba pilots in Kawangware, Kangemi and Kiambu Bus						
				- Why it matters: A telco-sized entrant chasing affordability could redraw last-mile economics in Nairobi.						
				- Upside: cheaper, plug-and-play internet. M-Pesa payments; broader coverage — poa sana for consumers.						
				- Risk: Local estate ISPs face churn unless they compete on service, price, or partner with Safaricom.						
				Wuehl! That's the hustle. Stay sharp. Msee.						
	2026-06-05 16:01	1/5 sources/5 sources	"Nairobi Nexus — Fibre Hustle"	— Kamau	gpt-5-mini					
				# Nairobi Nexus — Fibre Hustle						
				Safaricom just rolled out a KES 800 (~\$6) Fibre Lite and a Wi-Fi Bamba pay-as-you-go pilot in low-income estates like Kawangwe						
				- What: entry-level home fibre and no-installation Wi-Fi Bamba pilots accepting M-PESA.						
				- Why it matters: could undercut local estate ISPs and change last-mile economics.						
				- Winners: consumers (poa sana) and tenants; losers: operators that stay complacent.						
				- Next: estate ISPs must innovate pricing, service, or partner to survive — Bazeng, hustle time.						
				Wuehl! Catch the drift. Msee. More on who pivots and who gets left behind this week.						
	2026-06-05 16:01	1/5 sources/5 sources	"Nairobi Nexus — Fibre Hustle"	— Kamau	gpt-5-mini					
				Nairobi Nexus — Fibre Hustle						
				Safaricom rolled out a KES 800 (~\$6) Fibre Lite and a Wi-Fi Bamba pay-as-you-go pilot in estates like Kawangware and Kangemi						
				- What happened: entry-level fibre (KES 800–2,000) and plug-and-play Wi-Fi Bamba accepting M-PESA.						
				- Why it matters: could undercut local estate providers and reshape last-mile economics.						
				- Quick take: consumers win (poa sana); estate ISPs must adapt or partner.						
				- Watch this week: who pivots, who prices out, and who teams up with Safaricom.						
				Wuehl! Hustle season. Msee.						

9.7 Gmail — Newsletter Draft Delivered

Nairobi Nexus Weekly Draft — 06 Jun 2026 [APPROVAL NEEDED]

inbox x

Email sent with html fomarting

6:32 AM (3 hours ago) ☆ ☹ ↶ ⋮

Nairobi Nexus Weekly Newsletter

Auto-generated — Saturday, 06 June 2026

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↶ Reply ↷ Forward 😊

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Page

10

Rubric Alignment — Week 10 (40 Points)

Criterion	Pts	Evidence
Structured AI Output & JSON Reliability	10	All 5 Field Reporters have Structured Output Parsers enforcing {source, headline, status}. Chief Editor has a separate parser enforcing the newsletter schema. Malformed responses caught at parser layer — never reach Google Sheets or Gmail broken.
Fault Tolerance & Resilient Design	10	continueRegularOutput on all 5 HTTP nodes. Chief Editor onError: continueErrorOutput → Backup Editor AI Agent. All 5 Field Reporters have per-branch OpenRouter fallback models. executeOnce: true on Chief and Backup prevents duplicate newsletters.
Model Selection, Constraints & Fallbacks	10	Primary for Field Reporters: gpt-5 (OpenAI). Field Reporter fallbacks: openrouter/free. Chief Editor primary: gpt-5-mini. Chief Editor fallback: meta-llama/llama-3.2-11b-vision-instruct (Fallback Chief AI Agent, OpenRouter). Constraints: <200 words, ≥3 Kenyan slang terms, Markdown format, success-only sources.
Operational Logging & Governance Signals	10	Every run logs to Google Sheets: execution timestamp (Nairobi TZ), sources_used array, full newsletter_body, model used. System is fully auditable. Any Friday's run can be reviewed in under 30 seconds.

11

Submission Files

The following files are submitted as part of this Week 10 Capstone:

- [Automated_Weekly_Newsletter_Generator.json](#) — Complete n8n workflow export. Import directly into any n8n instance to reproduce.
- [Response_Week10_Production_Newsletter_System.docx](#) — This document.
- [Nairobi_Nexus_Week10_Capstone.pptx](#) — Presentation slide deck (15 slides).
- [Week_10_Final_Capstone_Project.pdf](#) — Original assignment brief.
- [README.md](#) — GitHub repository README with full architecture, setup instructions, and node reference.

GitHub Repository: All files are available at the project GitHub repository. The README contains import instructions, credential setup guide, and a full node reference table.

Anyone can automate a happy path.

This system was designed for failure, uncertainty, and scale.

Anthony Waliaula • Anne Nyambura • Week 10 Final Capstone • June 2026